BY ORDER OF THE COMMANDER
374TH AIRLIFT WING (PACAF)

YOKOTA AIR BASE INSTRUCTION

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Weather

WEATHER SUPPORT PLAN

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This instruction implements Air Force Policy Directive (AFPD) 15-1, *Weather Operations*; Air Force Doctrine Document (AFDD) 3-59, *Weather Operations;* Air Force Manual (AFMAN) 15-111, *Surface Weather Observations*; AFMAN 15-124, *Meteorological Codes; Department of the Air Force Instruction* (DAFI) 15-129, *Air and Space Weather Operation;* AFI 90-802, *Risk Management;* Pacific Air Forces Instruction (PACAFI) 15-101*, Weather Support for PACAF;* and United States Forces Japan Instruction (USFJI) 15-4001*, Tropical Cyclone Conditions of Readiness (TCCOR)*. This instruction establishes policy, procedures, and responsibilities to provide weather support to Yokota Air Base (AB) and the 374 Airlift Wing (AW). Additionally, this instruction provides general information for weather services, including weather observations and forecasts; weather warnings, watches, and advisories; space weather data, information dissemination, and base-wide reciprocal support. It applies to units assigned to the 374th Airlift Wing (374 AW), subordinate units, and units assigned, attached, or supported by Yokota Air Base (AB). Ensure that all records created as a result of processes prescribed in this publication are maintained in accordance with (IAW) AFI 33-322, *Records Management and Information Governance Program*, and disposed of IAW the Air Force Records Disposition Schedule (RDS) located at **https://www.my.af.mil/gcss-af61a/afrims/afrims/**. Refer recommended changes and questions about this publication to the Office of Primary Responsibility (OPR) using the AF Form 847, *Recommendation for Change of Publication;* route AF Forms 847 from the field through the appropriate functional chain of command.

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Chapter 1

GENERAL NFORMATION

1.1. Introduction. The mission of the 374th Operations Support Squadron Weather Flight (374 OSS/OSW) is to provide timely, relevant, and accurate operational weather support to the 374 AW and associated units assigned to Yokota AB, Japan. This includes weather staff support to Headquarters United States Forces Japan (USFJ) and Headquarters, Fifth Air Force (5 AF) when a Joint Meteorological Officer is assigned. This instruction establishes weather support by the 374 OSS/OSW not already defined in Joint and Air Force Directives, Instructions, Manuals, and Publications or in 374 AW operating instructions. Agencies requiring routine weather support not included in this document should contact the 374 OSS/OSW to arrange for and document routine weather support requirements.

1.2. Background.

1.2.1. The 374 OSS/OSW is focused on providing mission tailored weather information needed by assigned and associated units of Yokota AB for mission execution, resource protection, and staff support.

1.2.2. Weather Flight will maintain a support relationship with its regionally-aligned Operational Weather Squadron (OWS). Specific responsibilities of the 17th Operational Weather Squadron (17 OWS) and 374 OSS/OSW are defined in the Installation Data Page (IDP).

1.3. 374 OSS/OSW Operational Hours. Normal manning hours are 24/7, excluding airfield closures.

1.3.1. During closed hours, personnel will be on standby. A monthly standby roster will be provided to the 374 AW Command Post (374 AW/CP). If weather support is required, the stand-by forecaster can be contacted directly or through the 374 AW/CP.

1.4. 374 OSS/OSW Operating Location. The 374 OSS/OSW performs duties at the location shown in **Table 1.1**.

Table 1.1. Primary Location Contact Information.

PRIMARY OPERATING LOCATION	MAILING ADDRESS
Bldg 703, 374 Operations Support Squadron DSN: 315-225-7213 Alt DSN: 315-225-9004 Fax DSN: 315-225-9213 Email: 374oss.weather@us.af.mil	374 OSS/OSW Unit 5222, Bldg 703 APO, AP 96328-5222

1.5. Alternate Operating Location (AOL). In the event of a building evacuation, weather operations will be moved to the alternate location as shown in **Table 1.2**. For flight safety reasons, the 374 OSS/OSW will not evacuate during exercises. Most services and support will be provided but will require a case-by-case assessment dependent on communication line status, equipment status, etc. The Pilot to Metro Service Radio (PMSV) on UHF 344.6 MHz will not be available

while operating outside of the primary weather facility. There may be additional degraded services (e.g., weather products, pilot briefings, sensor data, etc.) dependent upon the communication systems status during the time of AOL use.

Table 1.2. Alternate Operating Location Contact Information.

ALTERNATE OPERATING LOCATION
Primary Location: Bldg 602, Rm 214, 36th Airlift Squadron DSN: 315-225-2716 **Secondary Location:** Bldg 1375, Rm 110, Radar, Airfield & Weather Systems (RAWS) DSN: 315-225-5885

1.6. Duty Priorities. To ensure high priority duties are accomplished in order of urgency, the 374 OSS/OSW will apply Risk Management principles to provide prioritized weather support in the following order of service:

Table 1.3. [374. OSS/OSW Duty Priorities.

Order of Priority	DUTIES
1	Perform Emergency War Order (EWO) Taskings
2	Execute 374 OSS/OSW Evacuation
3	Respond to Aircraft/Ground Emergencies/Mishaps
4	Issue/Disseminate Weather Warnings
5	Disseminate Urgent Upper Air (UUA) Pilot Reports (PIREP)
6	Issue/Disseminate Watches/Advisories
7	Respond to PMSV calls
8	Provide Weather Information to Air Traffic Control (ATC)
9	Perform Severe Weather Action Plan (SWAP) Procedures
10	Take/Augment/Disseminate Surface Weather Observations
11	Prepare and Disseminate Mission Execution Forecasts (MEFs)
12	Prepare/Disseminate Terminal Aerodrome Forecasts (TAFs)
13	Provide Weather Briefings, Other Weather Products, and Information
14	METWATCH/Amend weather products

15	Disseminate Standard PIREP
16	Respond to Support Assistance Request (SAR) or Request for Information
17	Provide Staff Briefings/Non-standard Weather Products
18	Accomplish Training
19	Accomplish Administrative Tasks/All other Routine Tasks

1.7. Assumptions, Shortfalls, and Limitations.

1.7.1. 374 OSS/OSW Assumptions. Weather support can only be provided if the appropriate facilities, funding, communications, personnel, and indigenous support (e.g., power, water, etc.) are available.

1.7.2. 374 OSS/OSW Limitations.

1.7.2.1. Any augmented observations taken from Building 703 do not allow the observer to see the entire aerodrome, particularly southwest through northwest. Lightning may not be seen due to distance, low clouds, or poor visibility. Thunder may not be heard because of flight-line noise. **Note:** There are no limitations to the airfield weather sensors, such as blocked wind sensors.

1.7.2.2. Interruption of the normal receipt of alphanumeric and graphic data via various interconnected weather data systems, Non-classified Internet Protocol Router Network (NIPRNET) or Secure Internet Protocol Router Network (SIPRNET), can severely degrade forecasting capabilities.

1.8. Weather Equipment and Technical Assistance. The 374 OSS/OSW relies heavily on various forms of equipment to provide weather support. Most noteworthy are the FMQ-19, FMQ-22, TMQ-53, Kestrel 4500/5500, Joint Environmental Toolkit (JET), Local Area Network (LAN), phones, and PMSV.

1.8.1. Equipment Maintenance. The table below lists the organizations responsible for preventive maintenance and repairs of meteorological and communication equipment:

Table 1.4. Organizations Responsible for Maintenance of Equipment.

Met. Equipment	Maintaining Organization
FMQ-19/FMQ-22	374 OSS/OSAM (RAWS), Mesotech
Kestrel 4500/5500	374 OSS/OSW
TMQ-53 (TMOS)	374 OSS/OSAM (RAWS)
Micro Weather Sensor	374 OSS/OSW
Comm. Equipment	**Maintaining Organization**
JET	Raytheon, Mesotech
LAN	374 CS/SCOO (Network Control Center)
Phones/Hotlines	374 CS/SCOIN (Telephone Maintenance)

UHF Radio and Remote Monitor Control (PMSV)	374 OSS/OSAM (RAWS)

1.8.1.1. The 374 OSS/OSW will conduct basic troubleshooting to determine the nature of the equipment outage using system manuals, local troubleshooting guides, or instructions available from 2nd Combat Weather Systems Squadron before contacting the appropriate help desk. With assistance from the help desk, 374 OSS/OSW personnel will generally be able to resolve most problems.

1.8.2. Certifying Newly Fielded Systems. The 374 OSS/OSW leadership will be the certifying official IAW AFI 17-130, *Cybersecurity Program Management*, for all newly fielded information systems. The certifying official will coordinate site certification and accreditation efforts of these systems with the Yokota AB IA office to obtain approval from the Designated Approval Authority. An Air Force Command, Control, Communications, Computers, and Intelligence Support Plan must accompany new systems. The System Program Office (SPO) responsible for the acquisition will provide the AFC4I Support Plan. For additional assistance and guidance, contact HQ 557 WW/2 SYOS.

1.9. Release of Weather Information to Non-DoD Agencies and Individuals. Most general weather parameters are available to be given to the general public, such as temperature, winds, humidity, and sky condition. However, specific weather information will not be released to non-DoD agencies/non-base agencies without approval from the 374 AW Public Affairs (374 AW/PA) and Legal (374 AW/JA) offices.

Chapter 2

AIRFIELD SUPPORT FUNCTION

2.1. General. The Airfield Support Function includes those actions that affect the Yokota aerodrome (defined as an area within a 5-statute mile (8,000 meters) radius of the center of the aerodrome). Examples include TAF support, weather observing, METWATCH, and resource protection. Resource protection and emergency actions resulting from weather events/natural disasters will be described in **Chapter 5**.

2.2. TAF Support. The Yokota AB TAF is required 7 days a week, 365 days a year, during published airfield hours unless coordinated otherwise. Issue times are 0600, 1400, and 2200 JST (2100, 0500, and 1300 Zulu). Japan does not observe daylight saving time. The TAF is valid for 30 hours. TAFs are produced by the 374 OSS/OSW and disseminated through JET or AFW-WEBS, if JET is inoperative. TAF specification/amendment criteria is listed in **Attachment 2**. TAF format and decoding instructions can be found in AFMAN 15-124, *Meteorological Codes*.

2.3. Points of Observation. On Yokota AB, the active FMQ-19 sensor suite is the primary observing site for the airfield. There are two sensors (i.e., two sites) with one near each end of the runway. The active sensor (and active observing site) will correspond to the active runway. When the FMQ-19 is inoperable and the airfield is open observations will be augmented (i.e., taken manually by an observer) at the end of the Distinguished Visitor's Garden walkway just east of Building 703. Refer to **paragraph 1.7.2.1** for augmented observation point limitations.

2.4. Primary Observation Equipment. All observations will be taken using the FMQ-19 unless the system is inoperative altogether (i.e., communication failure) or in part (e.g., sensor failure). The system continuously measures wind speed and direction, visibility, precipitation type and intensity, obscurations to vision, cloud height and depth, sky cover, temperature, dew point, atmospheric pressure, and lightning occurrence, location and frequency. Observations will be transmitted via the JET automated dissemination system hourly or whenever SPECI/LOCAL criteria dictate (See **Attachment 2**).

2.4.1. FMQ-19 Limitations.

2.4.1.1. This system is only able to sample atmospheric information in the immediate vicinity and may not provide an accurate representation of weather in the entire aerodrome complex. Therefore, ceilings and visibility will only be measured and reported from or above the official observation site.

2.4.1.2. When visibility changes rapidly, the FMQ-19 observation will lag the actual weather due to the time-averaged algorithms used by the system.

2.4.2. FMQ-19 Outage Procedures.

2.4.2.1. In the case of an FMQ-19 short-term outage, the 374 OSS/OSW will use the Kestrel during augmentation to provide limited weather data. The Kestrel is a hand-held weather observing device that measures wind speed, temperature, dew point temperature and pressure. It does not have the precision of other equipment and will be used as a short-term backup device only.

2.4.3. In the case of a long-term outage, the TMQ-53 Tactical Meteorological Observation System (TMOS) may be used. The TMQ-53 TMOS is a tactical weather observing instrument suitable for measuring the same weather parameters the FMQ-19 can measure.

2.4.3.1. TMQ-53s may be used for short-term training, during exercises, or when required to back-up fixed base weather observing system (FBWOS). Weather units will notify PACAF/A318 when utilizing the TMQ-53 as a back-up to the FBWOS for more than 72 consecutive hours.

2.5. Augmentation of Observation Equipment. Augmentation is the process of weather technicians manually adding or editing data to an observation generated by the FMQ-19. The two processes of augmentation are backup and supplementing IAW AFMAN 15-111, *Surface Weather Observations*.

Table 2.1. Mandatory Supplementary Weather Conditions.

Tornado (**+FC**) (**Notes** 1 & 2)
Waterspout (**+FC**) (**Notes** 1 & 2)
Funnel Cloud (**FC**) (**Notes** 1 & 2)
Freezing Precipitation (**FZDZ/FZRA**)
Ice Pellets (**PL**)
Hail (**GR**)
Sandstorm (**SS**)/Dust Storm (**DS**) (Note 3)
Volcanic Ash (**VA**)
Tower Visibility remark (Note 4)
Notes: 1. The immediate reporting of tornadic activity takes precedence over all other phenomena. 2. Be prepared to supplement whenever a tornado watch is valid or warning has been issued; regardless of airfield clousure status. 3. Based on local weather warning criteria; if no warning criteria exists, this is not required. 4. Only required during controlled airfield hours.

2.5.1. During airfield closure the only element required to be supplemented is tornadic activity per AFMAN 15-111, *Surface Weather Observations*. When the environment is favorable for tornadic activity, Severe Weather Action Procedures (SWAP) will be initiated (see **Chapter 5** for SWAP procedures) and the 374 OSS/OSW will ensure supplementation occurs as outlined in SWAP procedures. **Note:** AFMAN 15-111, *Surface Weather Observations*, requirement to only supplement observations for tornadic activity does not relieve the 374 OSS/OSW from their SWAP responsibilities during non-duty hours.

2.6. Supplementing FBWOS. 374 OSS/OSW personnel conduct a supplement FBWOS when backup augmentation is required. Weather conditions will be reevaluated at intervals not to exceed 20 minutes and when conditions in **Table 2.2** are observed or are forecast to occur within 60 minutes.

Table 2.2. Increased Weather Check/Observation Frequency.

Increase Frequency of Observation Thresholds
Ceiling forms below or decreases to less than 1,500 feet.
Ceiling dissipates or increases to equal or exceed 1,500 feet.
Visibility decreases to less than 3 statute miles (4800 meters).
Visibility increases to equal or exceed 3 statute miles (4800 meters).
Precipitation (any form).
Any Forecasted or Observed Mountain Wave Turbulence
Thunderstorms.
Fog or mist.
Any supplementary conditions listed in Table 2.1.
During mandatory AMOS back-up conditions (i.e. sensor outages during airfield operating hours)
Special Weather Observation (SPECI) or LOCAL thresholds (if augmenting).

2.7. Cooperative Weather Watch. Cooperative Weather Watch is the process whereby 374 OSS/OSAT, 374 OSS/OSAR, flying units, and Security Forces personnel notify the 374 OSS/OSW of any occurrence of weather conditions which could affect flight safety or resource protection. This process is primarily concerned with reports of tower visibility different from prevailing visibility, local PIREPs, and any occurrence of previously unreported weather conditions.

2.7.1. 374 OSS/OSAT task certified personnel will notify the 374 OSS/OSW when any of the following occur:

2.7.1.1. Tower prevailing visibility is evaluated to be less than 4 statute miles (6400 meters) and is different from the surface prevailing visibility.

2.7.1.2. Tornadoes or funnel clouds.

2.7.1.3. Thunder is heard and/or lightning is seen.

2.7.1.4. Any other meteorological condition that could cause impacts to flight safety or be critical to the safety or efficiency of other local operations and resources (e.g., hail, damaging winds, etc.).

2.7.1.5. Any weather information received from pilots for inclusion into a PIREP and/or surface observation will be relayed to 374 OSS/OSW within 5 minutes, or as soon as possible, after receipt for dissemination.

2.7.1.5.1. 374 OSS/OSAT and 374 OSS/OSAR will relay urgent PIREPs (as identified in **Table 2.3**., *Urgent PIREP Weather Conditions*, to the 17 OWS within 5 minutes, or as soon as possible, in the event that 374 OSS/OSW personnel are not on duty.

2.7.2. 374 OSS/OSW will reevaluate weather conditions and the accuracy of the automated observing system (AMOS) when information reported from a reliable source differs from the last disseminated observation. If the information is determined to be accurate and the AMOS is determined to be malfunctioning, the 374 OSS/OSW will follow established augmentation procedures.

2.7.3. 374 OSS/OSW will notify airfield leadership if continuous RVR reporting is needed during airfield closure hours. The RVR system requires the runway lights to be left on for the AMOS to work properly.

2.8. Meteorological Watch (METWATCH). METWATCH is a deliberate process for monitoring terrestrial weather or the space environment in an area or region. The purpose of a METWATCH is to identify observed conditions that significantly diverge from forecast conditions.

2.9. PMSV Support. The 374 OSS/OSW will monitor UHF 344.6 MHz frequency during operational hours and will solicit aircrews to provide PIREPs of weather conditions over this frequency. Aircrews will be provided current weather conditions and will be warned of weather hazards along their route of flight. However, the 374 OSS/OSW will not vector aircrews around hazards (only air traffic control personnel can vector aircraft).

2.9.1. Limitations. The PMSV operating range is restricted to line-of-sight transmissions between the aircraft and the ground at Yokota AB. The range is approximately 20-40 nautical miles (NM) at normal operating altitudes. Local terrain range restrictions exist from the southwest (SW) to the northwest (NW).

2.9.2. PMSV Outages. 374 OSS/OSW personnel will:

2.9.2.1. Notify 374 OSS/OSAT and 374 OSS/OSAA of any PMSV outage so that they can monitor the UHF 344.6 MHz frequency and advise aircrew attempting to contact Yokota METRO to contact the 374 AW/CP (frequency UHF 325.8MHz or VHF 128.0MHz, DSN 225-3740) for a phone patch to the 374 OSS/OSW (DSN 225-7213/225-9004). For additional PMSV services aircrews can find information in the Flight Information Publication (FLIP).

2.9.2.2. Contact the 374 OSS/OSAA and ensure information on PMSV outages is included in local Airfield Advisories and Notices to Airmen (NOTAMs).

2.9.2.3. Notify 374 OSS/OSAT, 374 OSS/OSAA and 374 AW/CP when the equipment has been restored to operational status.

2.10. Pilot Reports (PIREPs). PIREPs will be relayed to the 374 OSS/OSW via PMSV, phone-patch, 374 OSS/OSAT, 374 OSS/OSAR, or the 374 AW/CP. 374 OSS/OSAT, 374 OSS/OSAR and 374 AW/CP will relay all PIREPs and pertinent weather information to the weather technician within 5 minutes, or as soon as possible, after receiving dissemination. Any 374 AW aircrew encountering hazardous weather conditions, including large concentrations of birds, or other animals near the airfield, which jeopardize flight safety should report conditions to the 374 OSS/OSW IAW DAFMAN 11-202V3, *General Flight Rules*, paragraph 3.20.1..

2.10.1. Aircrews providing a PIREP must state location, flight level, significant weather observed (minimum one weather element), time of observation, and type of aircraft for a PIREP to be disseminated, IAW AFMAN 15-124, *Meteorological Codes*. Other useful weather

data for inclusion into a PIREP includes, but is not limited to flight level winds, bases/tops of clouds (approach ceilings), visibility (approach visibility), turbulence, icing, thunderstorms, hail, or low-level wind shear.

2.10.2. When conditions exist that may result in the conditions in **Table 2.3** to occur, 374 OSS/OSW will request 374 OSS/OSAT and 374 OSS/OSAR to increase PIREP solicitation.

Table 2.3. Urgent PIREP Weather Conditions.

Urgent PIREP Weather Conditions
Tornado, waterspout, or funnel cloud
Severe Icing
Severe or extreme turbulence, including Clear Air Turbulence (CAT)
Any Mountain Wave Turbulence
Low-Level Wind Shear (LLWS). (When the fluctuation in airspeed is 10 knots or more)
Hail (GR or GS)
Volcanic eruption and/or ash (VA) when reported by any source, in the air or the ground
Any condition that, in the judgment of the person entering the PIREP into the system, would present an extreme hazard to flight

2.11. Yokota Extended Outlook Forecast. A 5-day weather forecast product will be produced once every duty day (i.e., Mon-Fri). The product will include at a minimum: sky conditions, expected weather, wind direction and speed, high and low temperatures, and precipitation amount.

Chapter 3

MISSION WEATHER SERVICES

3.1. General. The Mission Weather Element (MWE) will use the Mission Execution Forecast (MEF) process to tailor weather products and provide decision-quality environmental information for mission planning and execution for the 374 AW. The TAF and the MEF for Yokota AB are the primary weather tools used in supporting 374 AW flying missions. While the TAF is a standardized product for airfields worldwide, the MEF is a mission weather product (MWP) tailored to specific customer requirements and specific missions. As a customized product, a MEF can be in almost any format. A local area weather sheet, a verbal flight weather briefing and a DD Form 175-1, *Flight Weather Briefing*, are all examples of MEFs.

3.2. 374 OSS/OSW Mission Details. The 374 OSS/OSW supports many different organizations, weapons systems, and missions which are limited by various weather parameters.

3.2.1. The 374 OSS/OSW provides tailored weather support to its primary flying customers with the accompanying missions and requirements which are listed in **Table 3.1**.

3.2.1.1. Increased awareness of mission limitations is necessary for properly tailored briefings and daily weather discussions. It is the responsibility of the flying units to notify the 374 OSS/OSW if a new weather limitation poses an impact on missions.

Table 3.1. Yokota AB Organizations Missions, and Requirements.

Organization	Mission	Requirements
36 AS (C-130)	Prepares for, and when tasked, conducts passenger and cargo movement, combat employment and sustainment, and aeromedical evacuation.	-see **Attachment 3** -all WWAs
459 AS (C-12 and UH-1)	Conduct Operational Support Airlift, Aeromedical Evacuation, and Search and Rescue missions across the Kanto Plain and throughout the Western Pacific	-see **Attachment 3** -all WWAs

3.2.2. Due to the size of the training areas, there are very few instances when weather will make an operating area completely unusable. Pilot discretion is used to determine mission GO/NO-GO criteria regardless of the weather phenomena listed in the MEF or the briefing provided.

3.3. Airframe Specific Weather Limitations. Mission Design Series (MDS) specific weather limitations are IAW AFMAN 11-202V3, *Flight Operations*, and MDS specific 11-series Volume 3 AFMANs. The tables provide the general airframe weather limitations based on 11-series AFMANs.

3.4. Mission Execution Forecast (MEF). The MEF is mission tailored environmental information describing a specific impact to an operational mission. The 374 OSS/OSW follows the DAFMAN 15-129, *Air and Space Weather Operations*, administrative MEF process to conduct deliberate forecast processes while developing, delivering, monitoring, and amending MEFs by

fusing perishable data with operational and strategic level weather forecast products into decision quality information for an operational end user.

3.4.1. The MEF will be issued at a minimum of Monday through Friday during normal 374 AW flying hours by 2030Z (0530 JST) or not later than either two hours prior to the first takeoff or 15 minutes prior to the weather decision time, whichever is earlier. The MEF will not be issued on weekends, holidays or down days unless mission requirements call for it to be produced.

3.4.2. The Yokota MEF contains, at a minimum, the following data: hourly take-off/recovery weather to include forecasted wind direction and speed, crosswinds, visibility, present weather, sky conditions, temperature/dew point, forecasted altimeter, DA and PA, current WWAs/TCCORs for Yokota AB, space weather impacts to UH, UHF and GPS for both day and nighttime, route weather forecasts for the Northwest, Northeast, Fuji/Camp Fuji, and Tokyo/Hardy Barracks quadrants, forecasted flight level winds, temperatures and freezing level over Yokota AB and Camp Fuji from FL005-FL100, airdrop winds for Yokota and Mt. Fuji, Tokyo Bay sea surface temperature for the day, and solar and lunar data, as well as the Atsugi TAF.

3.4.2.1. The MEF applies 36 AS and 459 AS aircraft sensitivities and mission requirements. Listings of these impacts are included in **Attachment 3**.

3.4.3. MEF Amendment Criteria: Amendments will be issued based on the discretion of the 374 OSS/OSW and per the amendment criteria listed in the table below.

Table 3.2. MEF Amendment Criteria.

MEF Amendment Criteria
Any forecasted or non-forecasted condition that crosses mission limiting thresholds (Attachment 3)
If altimeter is off +/- 0.08 inHg.
If wind direction and speed differ from TAF amendment criteria per DAFMAN 15-129
If temperature is off +/- 4 °C
Issuance or change of any WWA or TCCOR condition
Any other weather situation that, in the forecaster's opinion, requires an update.
Any changes relating to the potential for mountain wave turbulence

3.4.4. MEF Dissemination.

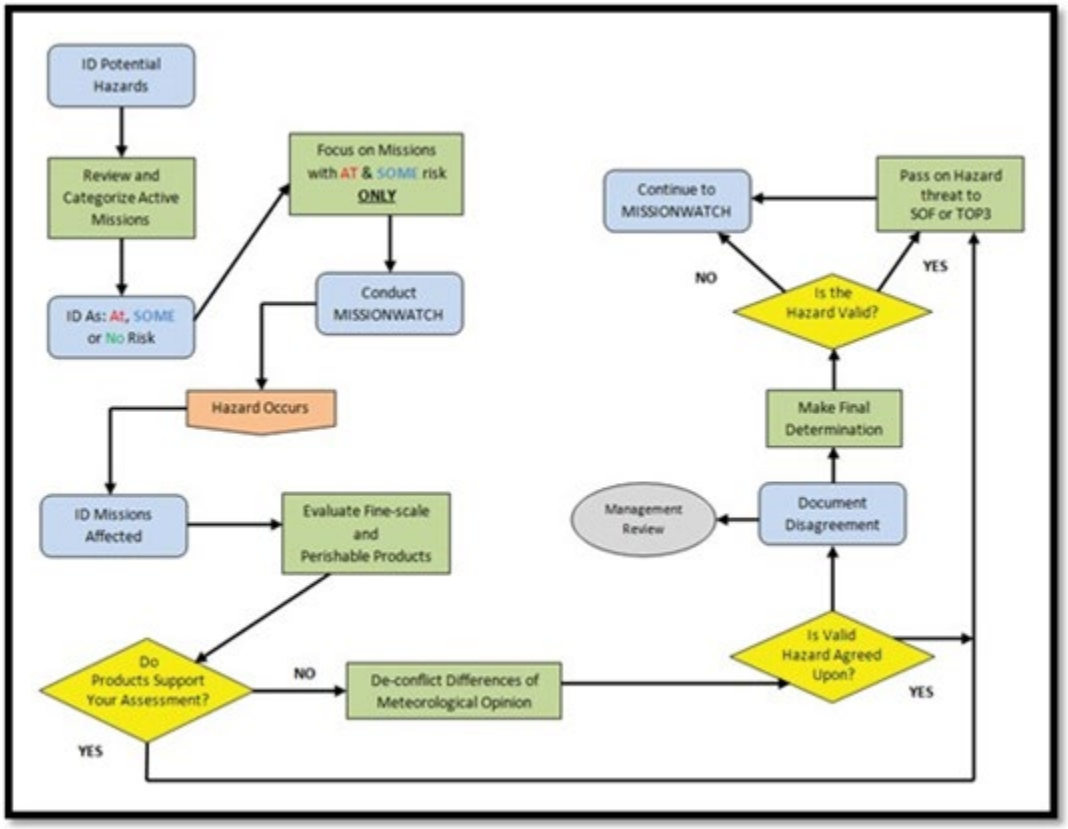
3.4.4.1. The Yokota AB MEF will be available on the 374 OSS/OSW SharePoint site at **https://usaf.dps.mil/sites/yokota/374AW/374OG/374OSS/OSW/SitePages/Home.aspx** and posted via Mattermost in the USAF-374AW team, 374 OSS Weather channel.

3.4.4.2. If LAN support is not available, the 374 OSS/OSW will disseminate the information to the 36 AS and 459 AS via email or hand delivery.

3.4.4.3. MEF Amendment Dissemination. Amended MEFs will be disseminated utilizing the same dissemination means as those listed above.

3.5. MISSIONWATCH. Process which describes how the 374 OSS/OSW monitors the weather for all missions through the use of the RM MISSIONWATCH process (**Figure 3.1**.). It is the primary responsibility of the duty forecaster to use all on-site meteorological and commercial data sources to accomplish this task. It is through this method that MEF amendments or updates are accomplished.

Figure 3.1. RM MISSIONWATCH Process.



3.5.1. The 374 OSS/OSW has established MISSIONWATCH procedures that aid forecasters in determining if the weather conditions will have a high or low risk impact on missions, to include those critical points in missions (e.g., takeoff, landing, airdrop, etc.).

3.5.1.1. If the weather conditions are determined to have little risk to a mission, the forecaster will reassess the weather conditions at least once an hour during the mission.

3.5.1.2. Weather conditions for high-risk missions will be reviewed every 20 minutes during the mission and 15 minutes prior to the following mission critical points: takeoff, landing, airdrop, and entry into a low-level route.

3.5.2. If any mission crosses one of the mission-limiting thresholds the 374 OSS/OSW will perform the following as required:

3.5.2.1. Notify 36 AS/459 AS Operations Desk(s), 374 OSS/OSAT, 374 OSS/OSAR, and the 374 AW/CP to pass the weather information to the aircrew(s).

3.5.2.2. Amend/update the MEF.

3.5.3. The 374 OSS/OSW will perform MISSIONWATCH for all missions that received and official weather brief with initials from the 374 OSS/OSW, for the entire duration of the mission.

3.5.3.1. If an aircraft is flying off-station, the 374 OSS/OSW will perform MISSIONWATCH until the aircraft reaches its final mission destination. If an aircraft will be staying off-station overnight or for a longer duration, the 374 OSS/OSW will cease MISSIONWATCH once the aircraft has landed off-station.

3.6. Aircrew Briefing Support. The 374 OSS/OSW will provide briefing support to 374 AW missions as requested. 374 OSS/OSW requests any 374 AW missions needing 175-1 support be coordinated via a briefing request made (via email, SharePoint, Mattermost, in person or over the phone) the duty day prior. The 374 OSW will expect the brief time to be 2 hours prior to take-off or 15 minutes prior to the weather decision time (whichever one comes first) unless otherwise notified by the crew or mission planners, with an initial request be made to 374 OSS/OSW no less than 24-hrs prior to the requested brief time. The 374 OSS/OSW will use standardized alternates unless otherwise requested. The 374 OSS/OSW will use daily flight schedules and/or GDSS to prepare the MEF for local missions 2 hours prior to the earliest takeoff time. 36 AS formation flights involving three or more C-130 aircraft will be briefed in-person by the 374 OSW when manning/mission requirements allow. Formal briefings will be posted on Mattermost 30 minutes prior to the requested brief time for flights of three or more aircraft or 5 minutes prior for single ship flights. It is the requestor's responsibility to notify 374 OSS/OSW of changes made to the mission after 1630L the day prior to the requested brief time.

3.6.1. **Integrated Flight Managed (IFM) Support.** The 374 OSS/OSW will provide weather support to IFM missions requested in GDSS IAW AFMAN 11-255V3, *Flying Operations*. If a 175-1 is used instead of the crew papers, the forecaster will upload/attach the 175-1 to the GDSS mission request in order for the flight manager at 613 AOC/AMD to receive the weather information. In the event that 374 OSS/OSW cannot provide support, 18 OSS/OSW (Kadena Weather Flight) will provide back-up weather support.

3.6.2. **Transient Support.** The 374 OSS/OSW will provide weather support to transient aircrews while manning or operations tempo permits. During normal duty days, the 374 OSS/OSW requests any 175-1 briefs be requested at least six hours in advance of the requested departure time, if time permits. If the 374 OSS/OSW cannot assist, they will provide/arrange for weather support with the crew's home unit or the appropriate Operational Weather Squadron.

3.7. Mission Planning Weather Outlook. The 374 OSS/OSW will provide planning weather upon request.

3.8. Space Weather. The 374 OSS/OSW will utilize the current suite of global and regional scale products provided by the 557 WW, the 17 OWS and any other relevant government site to relay relevant information to the 374 AWs operations as needed.

3.8.1. The 36 AS and 459 AS use communication systems that include High Frequency (HQ), Very High Frequency (VHF), Ultra High Frequency (UHF), Global Positioning System (GPS), Tactical Air Navigation System (TACAN), and Satellite Communications (SATCOM) which could be inhibited by increased solar activity. Space weather impacts are included in the MEF process.

3.9. National Airborne Operations Center (NAOC) Support. NAOC support is detailed in 374 AW Plan 553. The 374 OSS/OSW will provide environmental data for the aircrew as requested. A NAOC watch officer will be identified through the 374 AW/CP. The 374 OSS/OSW will notify the watch officer of all Yokota AB weather WWAs to include those additionally required advisories needed in support of the NAOC mission. Advisories are listed in **Table 3.3**.

Table 3.3. NAOC Support Advisories.

NAOC Support Advisories:	
Visibility < 1 SM	Observed
Thunderstorms within 50 NM	Observed
Thunderstorms within 25 NM	Observed
Thunderstorms within 10 NM	Observed
Crosswinds > 20 KTS	Observed
Crosswinds > 12 KTS (wet runway)	Observed
Turbulence ≥ moderate within 50 NM and below 10,000ft MSL (outside TSTMS)	Observed
Icing ≥ moderate within 50nm and below 10,000ft MSL (outside TSTMS)	Observed
Snowfall ≥ trace *but* less than 2 inches	Forecast

Chapter 4

STAFF INTEGRATION FUNCTION

4.1. General. Staff services are those briefings or support provided primarily by the 374 OSS/OSW leadership. These unit members will function as a direct interface with the 374 AW commander and staff, and provide direct support to command, control, and planning functions. Weather technicians will be integrated into the staff weather element as needed.

4.2. Staff Weather Briefings. Weather is briefed at several organizational staff meetings. Briefing times, content, and delivery method are tailored to the customer's situational requirements and are subject to change at any time. Generalized descriptions of the briefings are as follows:

4.2.1. **374 AW Staff Meetings.** For briefings at the 374 AW or 374 OG level, the weather data presented usually consists of a 5-day outlook of forecasted weather limitations to operations at major installations in the AOR. Tropical cyclone forecasts and analysis are included when tropical cyclones are present in the AOR.

4.2.2. **Emergency Operations Center (EOC).** The 374 OSS/OSW supports EOC exercises and real-world events with atmospheric/environmental data as requested.

4.2.3. **Crisis Action Team (CAT).** IAW Yokota Air Base Installation Emergency Management Plan 10-2 (IEMP 10-2)*:*

4.2.3.1. The 374 OSS/OSW will advise the 374 AW/CC or designated representative and the CAT on weather related concerns and the potential for detrimental mission impact.

4.2.3.2. For any CAT activation resulting from weather related phenomenon, have a representative positioned to support the CAT and provide weather updates for the duration of the event.

4.3. Defense Threat Reduction Agency (DTRA) Briefings. In person briefings will be provided to the DTRA team as requested. At a minimum, those briefs will consist of flight weather (take-off, enroute, and destination weather), inspection location(s) forecasted weather, and forecasted return flight weather.

4.4. ATC Limited Observation Program. The 374 OSS/OSW will provide initial observation training for 374 OSS/OSAT and 374 OSS/OSAR personnel in a Limited Observation Training Program. This training is designed to enable the Cooperative Weather Watch program. New 374 OSS/OSAT and 374 OSS/OSAR personnel who have not been trained will call the 374 OSS/OSW and schedule an appointment with the 374 OSS/OSW Training Manager. At the end of training, personnel are tested for qualification and will receive a familiarization tour of the weather station.

4.5. Climatology Briefings. The 374 OSS/OSW provides climatology information during the 374 AW Quarterly Safety Briefings, coordinated through 374 AW/SEF. All other climatology support will be provided when requested.

4.6. Flight Information Publication (FLIP) Weather Updates. The 374 OSS/OSW will provide information to the Airfield Manager for FLIP entries. Data includes, but is not limited to, 374 OSS/OSW operating hours, PMSV frequency and user information, and 17 OWS contact information. 374 OSS/OSW is responsible to ensure that weather data listed in FLIP is accurate

and will coordinate changes with the Airfield Manager and take immediate steps to correct erroneous data.

4.7. Pre-Deployment Planning. The 374 AW will make every effort to include the 374 OSS/OSW in planning and operations for war, contingency, and military operations other than war. The 374 OSS/OSW leadership will do the following:

4.7.1. Provide pre-deployment planning briefings, if requested. The briefings will contain requested environmental information for deployed location.

4.7.2. Participate in pre-deployment planning to ensure theater-specific environmental impacts are properly factored in the 374 AW deployment activities.

4.7.3. Coordinate reach-back support from the appropriate OWS, if required.

4.7.4. Perform operational checks on TMQ-53 and other tactical weather equipment.

Chapter 5

RESOURCE PROTECTION SERVICES

5.1. Weather Watches, Warnings, and Advisories (WWAs). Resource protection is accomplished by the 374 OSS/OSW. The 374 OSS/OSW is responsible for issuing, extending or cancelling all forecasted and observed weather watches, warnings, and advisories. During airfield closure hours, the 17 OWS will continue to track any volcanic eruptions, earthquakes and/or tsunamis and recall the 374 OSS/OSW standby member. The goal is to provide the best possible resource protection to Yokota Air Base. Weather WWAs are documented in the 374 OSS/OSW-17 OWS IDP. See **Attachment 4** for customer weather limitations and sensitivities. Each watch, warning, and advisory will be assigned a number following the two-digit number of the current month (e.g., 06-001 would be the first watch, warning, or advisory in the month of June).

5.1.1. Weather Watches. A weather watch is a special notice sent to Yokota AB agencies indicating that conditions are favorable for the development of a particular type of weather phenomena of such intensity to pose a hazard to life or property for which protective measures should be considered. Watches are issued for a 5 nautical mile radius of the center point of the Yokota runway complex. **Table 5.1** contains all of the weather watches and desired lead times issued for Yokota AB. Forecast weather watches are issued IAW DAFMAN 15-129, *Air and Space Weather Operations*, and local requirements.

Table 5.1. Yokota AB Forecast Weather Watches.

Phenomena	DLT	ISSUED BY
Lightning within 5 nm	30 minutes	374 OSS/OSW
Tornado or Funnel Cloud	As potential warrants	374 OSS/OSW
Freezing Precipitation	As potential warrants	374 OSS/OSW
Surface Winds ≥ 50 knots	As potential warrants	374 OSS/OSW
Heavy Rain ≥ 2 inches in 6 hours	As potential warrants	374 OSS/OSW
Heavy Snow Accumulation ≥ 2 inches in 12 hours	As potential warrants	374 OSS/OSW
Moderate Thunderstorm (winds ≥ 35 knots but < 50 knots and/or any hail < 3/4 inch)	As potential warrants	374 OSS/OSW
Severe Thunderstorm (winds ≥ 50 knots and/or hail > 3/4 inch)	As potential warrants	374 OSS/OSW
Blizzard Conditions (duration ≥ 3 hrs, wind or gusts ≥ 30 kts, falling and/or blowing snow with visibility ≤ 1/4 SM)	As potential warrants	374 OSS/OSW
Excessive Rainfall (potential exists for 4 1/2 inches of rain in 24 hours)	48 hours	374 OSS/OSW

5.1.2. Weather Warnings. Weather Warnings (WW) are special notices provided to an installation personnel/operational user to notify them when an established weather condition of such intensity as to pose a hazard to life or property is occurring or is expected to occur. Warnings are issued for a 5 nautical mile radius of the center-point of the Yokota AB runway complex. Forecast warnings and desired lead times are contained in **Table 5.2**. Forecast weather warnings are issued IAW DAFMAN 15-129, *Air and Space Weather Operations*, and local requirements.

5.1.2.1. Observed Lightning WWs. Lightning Warnings are issued by the 374 OSS/OSW when lightning is observed or detected within 5 nautical miles of the airfield IAW DAFMAN 91-203, *Air Force Occupational Safety, Fire and Health Standards*.

5.1.2.2. The 374 OSS/OSW will issue observed lightning warnings separately from, and at times concurrent with, an issued warning for any other criteria. The observed lightning and tornado WW are the only warnings that may be issued separately from warnings for other criteria.

5.1.2.3. The 374 OSS/OSW will include a statement in the lightning and tornado WW cancellation message indicating the effect on any previously issued warnings.

Table 5.2. Yokota AB Weather Warnings.

Phenomena	DLT	ISSUED BY
Lightning within 5 nm	Observed	374 OSS/OSW
Tornado	30 minutes	374 OSS/OSW
Freezing Precipitation	90 minutes	374 OSS/OSW
Surface Winds ≥ 35 knots but < 50 knots	90 minutes	374 OSS/OSW
Surface Winds ≥ 50 knots	120 minutes	374 OSS/OSW
Heavy Rain ≥ 2 inches rain in 6 hours	90 minutes	374 OSS/OSW
Heavy Snow Accumulation ≥ 2 inches in 12 hours	90 minutes	374 OSS/OSW
Severe Thunderstorm (winds ≥ 50 knots and/or hail ≥ 3/4 inch)	120 minutes	374 OSS/OSW
Moderate Thunderstorm (winds ≥ 35 knots but < 50 knots and/or any hail < 3/4 inch)	90 minutes	374 OSS/OSW
Blizzard (duration ≥ 3 hrs, wind or gusts ≥ 30 kts, falling and/or blowing snow with visibility ≤ 1/4 SM)	90 minutes	374 OSS/OSW
Excessive Rainfall (4 1/2 inches of rain in 24 hours is expected to occur)	18 hours	374 OSS/OSW

5.1.3. Weather Advisories (WA). Weather Advisories are special notices provided to an operational user to notify them of environmental conditions impacting operations that is occurring or is expected to occur within a 5 nautical mile radius of the center-point of the Yokota AB runway complex. Forecast advisories and desired lead times are contained in **Table 5.3**. Forecast weather advisories are issued IAW DAFMAN 15-129, and local requirements.

5.1.3.1. If the 374 OSS/OSW evacuates its primary duty location and is unable to provide Observed Weather Advisory support from its location, the 17 OWS will assume responsibility for Observed Weather Advisories if the capability to METWATCH exists (i.e., the wind sensor must be operational).

Table 5.3. Yokota AB Weather Advisories.

Phenomena	DLT	ISSUED BY
Surface Winds ≥ 25 knots but < 35 knots	Observed	374 OSS/OSW
Snow Accumulation ≥ 1/2 inch	120 minutes	374 OSS/OSW
Freezing Temperature	Observed	374 OSS/OSW
Crosswinds ≥ 25 knots	Observed	374 OSS/OSW
Low-Level Wind Shear below 2,000 feet	Observed	374 OSS/OSW
Moderate or Greater Turbulence below 10,000 feet AGL	Observed	374 OSS/OSW
Moderate or Greater Icing below 10,000 feet AGL	Observed	374 OSS/OSW
Rain greater than or equal to 1/2 inch within 1/2 hour	Observed	374 OSS/OSW
Rain greater than or equal to 1 inch within 1 hour	Observed	374 OSS/OSW
Heat Stress Advisory(ies)	Observed	374 DS/SGPB

5.1.4. Tama Service Annex. IAW the Yokota AB IDP, the following paragraphs outline WWA support to the Tama Service Annex:

5.1.4.1. For the Tama Service Annex, the watch for lightning within 5 nautical miles will be issued during daylight hours, 2100Z – 1300Z (0600 JST – 2200 JST).

Table 5.4. Tama Service Annex (of Yokota AB) Forecast Weather Watch.

Phenomena	DLT	ISSUED BY
Lightning within 5 NM (2100Z – 1300Z only)	30 minutes	374 OSS/OSW

5.1.4.2. For the Tama Service Annex, the warning for lightning within 5 nautical miles will be issued anytime the phenomenon is occurring during the designated times listed above.

Table 5.5. Tama Service Annex (of Yokota AB) Weather Warning.

Phenomena	DLT	ISSUED BY

Lightning within 5 NM (24/7)	Observed	374 OSS/OSW

5.1.5. WWA Upgrades and Downgrades. Advisories and warnings will be upgraded (e.g., winds increase from 35 knots to 50 knots) or downgraded as required. Upgrades should meet the desired lead-times specified above.

5.1.6. WWA Amendments. Amendments to weather warnings and watches will only be issued to change the valid time and will be issued before the **original** watch or warning expires. New warnings and watches will be issued for any changes in weather criteria.

5.1.7. WWA Cancellation. Warnings and watches may be cancelled when the weather phenomena are no longer occurring or expected to occur. However, if not cancelled, they will expire at the end of the valid period. Observed advisories will be cancelled when the criterium is no longer occurring and is not expected to occur again in the next hour.

5.1.8. WWA Dissemination. The primary mode of dissemination is through JET. If it is out of service, the 374 OSS/OSW will contact 374 OSS/OSAA, 374 AW/CP, and any required agencies.

5.1.8.1. Airfield Management Operations Section (OSAA) WWA Notifications**.** OSAA notifies all organizations as required. OSAA will ONLY notify the 36 AS, 459 AS, and applicable contractors when a weather advisory or watch has been issued. However, OSAA will notify all agencies via the SCN for ALL weather warnings, except for the following:

5.1.8.1.1. Contractors on airfield are notified via radio.

5.1.8.1.2. 36 AS and 459 AS Operations Desks are notified via phone hotline.

5.1.8.2. 374 AW/CP WWA Notifications. 374 AW/CP personnel will disseminate all WWA via the Installation Warning System (IWS) and/or accomplish telephonic notifications, 374 AW/CP WWA Notification Tables using the appropriate CP quick reaction checklist.

5.2. Severe Weather Action Procedures (SWAP). SWAP is in place to ensure that the 374 OSS/OSW has sufficient personnel available during potential/actual severe weather or natural disaster events which may have significant impacts on operations and/or personnel. See **Table 5.6** for conditions requiring SWAP activation.

Table 5.6. Conditions requiring SWAP.

Conditions requiring SWAP Activation
Tornado
Severe Thunderstorms (wind ≥ 50kt and/or hail ≥ 3/4”)
Any Forecasted Hail
Damaging Wind (≥ 50kt)
Freezing Precipitation
*Volcanic Activity (see note 1)
*Earthquakes (see note 1)

*Tsunamis (see note 1)
Note 1: 374 OSS/OSW leadership will assess the need to activate SWAP

5.2.1. SWAP Activation. SWAP can be requested by the Duty Forecaster and activated by the 374 OSS/OSW Flight Commander, Flight Chief, or Airfield NCOIC.

5.3. Tropical Cyclone Procedures. The 374 OSS/OSW will monitor all tropical storms or typhoons that are forecasted in the Pacific region, using the forecast tracks produced by the Joint Typhoon Warning Center (JTWC). The 374 OSS/OSW will keep 374 AW, USFJ, and 5 AF leadership informed of the current situation and forecast track of the storm. Units will not deviate from the broad overarching official forecast but have leeway to depict weather impacts for their installation based on the localized effects expected. However, 374 OSS/OSW will also stress that the accuracy of the forecasts beyond 72 hours is subject to a wide margin of error.

5.3.1. The 374 OSS/OSW will provide tropical cyclone briefings as requested by the 374 AW, USFJ, and 5 AF leadership IAW Yokota Air Base IEMP 10-2.

5.3.1.1. In the event the 374 AW decides to evacuate aircraft, the 374 OSS/OSW will provide mass weather briefings at the 459 AS and 36 AS, as needed.

5.3.2. TCCOR levels are conditions of readiness designed to guide personnel in preparations for a tropical cyclone impact. Per USFJ Instruction 15-4001, TCCOR level(s) are issued for the Kanto Plain. The TCCOR authority is COMUSFJ and authority is normally delegated to the USFJ/J3. The OSS/OSW is responsible for providing USFJ/J3 with TCCOR recommendations as outlined in USFJ Instruction 15-4001, *Tropical Cyclone Conditions of Readiness*, for all installations within the Kanto Plain (Yokota AB, NAF Atsugi, Camp Zama, and Camp Fuji) as well as 374 AW leadership TCCOR recommendations for Yokota AB (see **Table 5.7**.).

5.3.2.1. JTWC will hold conference calls discussing storm impacts across US military assets once a storm is forecasted to impact a location. The 374 OSS/OSW will attend these telephone conferences once a storm is expected to impact the Kanto Plain.

5.3.2.2. Tropical cyclone update emails will be provided every 12 hours when there is a numbered tropical system in the West Pacific. TCCOR status updates will be sent out anytime there is a change to TCCOR criteria (see **Table 5.7**.). The 374 OSS/OSW will implement SWAP as discussed in **paragraph 5.2** when TCCOR 2 has been declared for Yokota AB.

Table 5.7. TCCOR Criteria and Destructive Winds.

Destructive Winds are defined as 50 knots sustained or greater, or 60 knots or greater wind gusts.	
TCCOR 5	Destructive winds are *possible* within 96 hours.
TCCOR 4	Destructive winds are *possible* within 72 hours.
TCCOR 3	Destructive winds are *possible* within 48 hours.
TCCOR 2	Destructive winds *anticipated* within 24 hours.
TCCOR 1	Destructive winds *anticipated* within 12 hours.

TCCOR 1 **Emergency**	Destructive winds are occurring on the installation.
TCCOR Recovery*	After the passage of a TC when destructive winds have subsided, work and survey crews are sent out to determine the extent of damage and to establish safe zones around hazards. Until the recovery process is declared complete (TCCOR All Clear), the general base population would normally be asked to remain indoors.
TCCOR All Clear*	The storm is over and not forecast to return and recovery efforts are considered complete by the installation commander.
TCCOR Storm Watch	Strong winds of 35 knots sustained or greater are possible due to the proximity of a tropical cyclone; however, winds are not forecasted to meet the destructive wind criteria. The storm is also close enough to the area that a heightened alert status is necessary in order to rapidly establish regular TCCOR condition should the storm deviate from the forecast track. Personnel should follow Standard Operation Procedures for TCCOR Storm Watch and stay alert for any changes to TCCOR status.
***Note**: For Yokota AB, the TCCOR Authority is typically delegated to USFJ/J3; however, TCCOR 1 Emergency/Recovery/All Clear are delegated to the Installation Commander by the TCCOR Authority. The wind definitions stated are a guideline. Local commanders can set these conditions as required for the safety and protection of their service members, families, and facilities.	

5.3.3. 17 OWS Support. The 17 OWS will track environmental conditions, such as volcanic eruptions and earthquakes while the airfield is closed and serve as the primary liaison between JTWC and the 374 OSS/OSW.

Table 5.8. Mandatory Forecasted Weather Parameters.

Mandatory Forecasted Weather Parameters
15KT crosswinds
25KT crosswinds
35KT sustained winds
50KT sustained winds
65KT gusts
Max forecasted winds
Amount of precipitation expected

5.3.3.1. WWAs will be issued until Yokota AB is directed to implement TCCOR 1. Once TCCOR 1 is implemented, the only WWAs that will be issued are the observed lightning and tornado warnings. All other criteria (with the exception of frozen precipitation due to

the nature of tropical cyclones), are considered possible after such time that Yokota AB assumes TCCOR 1. WWA issuance will resume after TCCOR Recovery or All Clear has been declared, whichever is first.

5.4. Emergency/Crisis Action Response. In the event of an aircraft or ground mishap, the 374 OSS/OSW will do the following:

5.4.1. Make a log of the incident to include as much known data about the incident.

5.4.2. Increase METWATCH.

5.4.2.1. When the FMQ-19 is in automated observing mode, forecasters will reassess the weather conditions from the official observation point to ensure the FMQ-19 is reporting correctly and supplement weather conditions if needed.

5.4.2.2. If the FMQ-19 is in augmentation back-up mode, forecasters will take and disseminate a SPECI observation.

5.4.3. Inform 374 OSS/OSW flight leadership of the incident.

5.4.4. Inform the 17 OWS of the incident and request a data save be completed by the 17 OWS (or the appropriate servicing OWS if the mission crossed AORs).

5.4.5. Create a mishap folder and save the following weather data and products produced at least 12 hours prior to the incident through 2 hours after the incident: radar images, METSAT imagery, JET incident archive, upper air and surface analysis package, hazard charts, JMA PIREP and SIGMET chart(s), TAFs and observations (departure point, destination, and alternates), WWAs, nearest upper air sounding, copies of briefing material (DD Form 175-1, MEF, Verbal Brief Log, etc.), AF Form 3803, current/previous forecasts, surface observations near the location of the incident, PMSV log, and daily shift log.

5.4.6. Save all weather data/products to the folder labeled “Data Save” in the Airfield Services folder on the network drive, deliver to the 374 OSS/OSA Flt/CC for inclusion into their mishap archive, and inform Wing Safety that the weather archive is complete and with the Airfield Operations Flight Commander.

5.4.7. Generate an OPREP-3 report, when required, and ensure it is passed to 374 AW/CP and PACAF A318 as per local regulations. The report will also be passed to the CAT, if activated.

5.5. Severe Weather Damage Reporting/OPREPs. The 374 OSS/OSW leadership will submit OPREP-3 data IAW DAFMAN 15-129, *Air and Space Weather Operations*, and AFMAN 10-206, *Operational Reporting*, when one of the following occurs:

5.5.1. When the 374 AW/CP requests weather information due to damage/mishap report(s) or significant impacts on operations. Typically, these requests are a result of winds greater than or equal to 50kts, hail greater than or equal to ¾ inch, tornadoes, lightning strikes, snowstorms, heavy rain, tropical cyclones, and TCCOR declaration/changes.

5.5.2. The 374 OSS/OSW will provide the information listed in **Table 5.9** to the 374 AW/CP and PACAF A318.

5.5.2.1. Should the 374 AW/CP submit an OPREP-3 report, they will provide a copy to the 374 OSS/OSW. The 374 OSS/OSW will then forward that report to PACAF A318.

Table 5.9. Items Required for OPREP-3 Report.

#	Item
1.	The actual severe weather experienced including:
	a. Location.
	b. Date and Time.
	c. Phenomenon.
2.	Forecast and observation that was valid at the time of occurrence.
3.	Any WWAs issued including.
	a. Issue date and time.
	b. Valid time.
	c. Actual lead-time.
	d. Customers desired lead-time.
4.	Operational status of meteorological equipment prior to the severe weather event.

5.6. Natural Disasters. In the case of natural disasters, the 374 OSS/OSW will follow the actions under the Yokota Air Base IEMP 10-2. In addition, they will do the following:

5.6.1. Volcanic Ash. The 374 OSS/OSW will monitor the Tokyo Volcanic Ash Advisory Center (VAAC) website, AFW-WEBS, and Japan Meteorological Agency (JMA) for volcanic ash plume advisories. If the 374 OSS/OSW leadership determines that volcanic ash will affect Yokota AB, 374 AW leadership will be advised.

5.6.2. 374 OSS/OSW leadership will assess the need to initiate SWAP procedures depending on the severity of the natural disaster and response efforts or as directed.

5.7. Chemical Biological, Radiological, Nuclear and High-Yield Explosive (CBRNE).

5.7.1. The 374 OSS/OSW will provide weather data and evaluate the accuracy of transport model data against any/all relevant observation data available as requested by the installation Emergency Manager (EM), Fire Emergency Services (FES), and Bioenvironmental Engineering (BEE).

5.7.2. Chemical Downwind Messages (CDM). The 374 OSS/OSW will provide BEE with official winds for use in their CDM products.

Chapter 6

BASE AGENCY SUPPORT

6.1. General. This chapter contains the specific local requirements submitted by various organizations throughout Yokota AB and verified by the 374 OSS/OSW leadership. The requirements will be reviewed annually by the requesting unit and updated as required. If the MEF or a weather watch, warning, or advisory does not cover a specific local weather requirement, it is the responsibility of the individual unit to contact the 374 OSS/OSW to coordinate support.

6.2. 374 AW Commander (374 AW/CC) will:

6.2.1. Review and approve the Yokota AB Instruction 15-101, *Weather Support Plan*, at a frequency no less than biennially.

6.3. 374 AW Command Post (374 AW/CP) will:

6.3.1. Sound the Giant Voice siren in the event of a tornado warning for Yokota AB.

6.3.2. Disseminate weather watches, warnings, and advisories to organizations found in the Yokota AB notification tree and through Yokota's Installation Warning System (IWS).

6.3.3. Notify the 374 OSS/OSW if the primary phone lines go out and use alternate numbers to pass weather watch, warning, and advisory notification.

6.3.4. Serve as a point of contact (POC) between enroute aircraft and the 374 OSS/OSW for phone patch weather requests.

6.3.5. Notify the 374 OSS leadership and 374 OSS/OSW of Crisis Action Team (CAT) activation and changes to assembly times.

6.3.6. Notify the 374 OSS leadership and 374 OSS/OSW of Emergency Operations Center (EOC) activation.

6.3.7. Notify Wing leadership and various base agencies of severe weather when notified by OSAA via Secondary Crash Net (SCN).

6.3.8. Notify the 374 OSS/OSW when any agency reports a funnel cloud, tornado, or significant weather event.

6.3.9. Notify the 374 OSS/OSW upon receipt of a volcanic ash advisory/warning that may impact the Kanto Plain.

6.3.10. Notify the 374 OSS/OSW upon receipt of an earthquake (magnitude 6.0 or greater) or any tsunami notification affecting Japan.

6.3.11. Provide the 374 OSS/OSW with a copy of any OPREP-3 reports which contain weather information.

6.3.12. Provide the 374 OSS/OSW with a copy of any Post Tropical Cyclone Report sent to USFJ.

6.4. 374 AW Safety (374 AW/SE) will:

6.4.1. Request seasonal weather briefings from the 374 OSS/OSW for AW-sponsored safety events. 374 AW/SE and 374 OSS/OSW will collaborate to determine the best topics to present to the 374 AW aircrews.

6.5. 374 AW Public Affairs (374 AW/PA) will:

6.5.1. Coordinate news feed to AFN channels during significant weather events when deemed necessary by 374 AW leadership (e.g., typhoons, heavy snow, etc.).

6.6. 374 Operations Support Squadron (374 OSS) will:

6.6.1. ***Airfield Operations Section (374 OSS/OSA).***

6.6.1.1. Airfield Management Operations Section (OSAA) will:

6.6.1.1.1. Ensure dissemination of weather watches, warnings, and advisories as outlined in this instruction.

6.6.1.1.2. Notify the 374 OSS/OSW of any aircraft mishap via the SCN.

6.6.1.1.3. Notify the 374 OSS/OSW of initial conditions and all changes in Runway Surface Condition (RSC) and Runway Condition Readings (RCR).

6.6.1.1.4. Notify the 374 OSS/OSW of all changes to published approach minimums.

6.6.1.1.5. Provide an airfield orientation for 374 OSS/OSW personnel.

6.6.1.1.6. Coordinate with 374 OSS/OSW on changes to Yokota Air Base Instruction 13-204, *Airfield Operations*.

6.6.1.1.7. Monitor frequency 344.6 MHz frequency during normal duty hours, when PMSV is inoperable (374 OSS/OSAT will monitor the frequency until OSAA receives proper equipment).

6.6.1.1.8. Immediately notify 374 OSS/OSW leadership when a FLIP has been published.

6.6.1.2. ***Air Traffic Control (374 OSS/OSAT) will*:**

6.6.1.2.1. Perform a Cooperative Weather Watch IAW AFI 13-204V3, *Airfield Operations Procedures and Programs*. At a minimum, controllers will notify the 374 OSS/OSW duty forecaster when conditions outlined in **Chapter 2 paragraph 2.7** of this document occur.

6.6.1.2.2. Solicit aircraft for PIREPs IAW FAAO 7110.65 2-6-3.

6.6.1.2.3. Provide a tower orientation for 374 OSS/OSW personnel.

6.6.1.2.4. Notify the 374 OSS/OSW forecaster when the operational runway changes.

6.6.1.2.5. Immediately notify 374 OSS/OSW when a JET outage is discovered.

6.6.1.3. ***Radar Approach Control, RAPCON (374 OSS/OSAR) will:***

6.6.1.3.1. Provide a RAPCON orientation for 374 OSS/OSW personnel.

6.6.1.3.2. Immediately notify 374 OSS/OSW when a JET outage is discovered.

6.6.1.4. ***Radar, Airfield, and Weather Systems (374 OSS/OSAM) will:***

6.6.1.4.1. Maintain all authorized government weather sensing and display equipment at Yokota AB, and Hardy Barracks IAW the 374th Operations Support Squadron Radar Airfield Weather Systems (RAWS) Maintenance Operations Agreement (MOA) 15 AUG 2024.

6.6.1.4.2. Maintain all technical orders to meteorological equipment and advise operators of significant changes.

6.6.1.4.3. Coordinate with the 374 OSS/OSW on routine maintenance to ensure it does not impact mission support.

6.6.2. ***Weapons & Tactics Flight (374 OSS/OSK) will:***

6.6.2.1. Provide 374 OSS/OSW with graphics depicting new flight training routes.

6.6.3. ***Weather Flight (374 OSS/OSW) will:***

6.6.3.1. Provide the following to the 374 AW/CP:

6.6.3.1.1. Notification of all issued, cancelled, or extended weather watches, warnings, and advisories.

6.6.3.1.2. Weather data for OPREP-3 reports IAW OPREP-3 reporting procedures in AFMAN 10-206, *Operational Reporting*.

6.6.3.1.3. Notification when 374 OSS/OSW must evacuate to the Alternate Operating Location.

6.6.3.2. Provide the following to the 374 AW/SE:

6.6.3.2.1. Weather briefings for safety events and other safety briefings when requested.

6.6.3.2.2. Worldwide weather data pertinent to an aircraft mishap or accident.

6.6.3.3. Provide the following to the 374 AW/PA:

6.6.3.3.1. Notification of non-governmental requests for weather information.

6.6.3.4. Provide the following to the 374 OSS/OSAA:

6.6.3.4.1. Notification of issued, cancelled, or extended weather watches, warnings, and advisories.

6.6.3.4.2. Notification of meteorological equipment outages to be include in a NOTAM.

6.6.3.4.3. Input for FLIP entries.

6.6.3.4.4. Accuracy validation of the weather support information each time the FLIP is published and immediate actions to correct erroneous data.

6.6.3.4.5. Notify airfield leadership if continuous RVR reporting is needed during airfield closure hours. The RVR system requires the runway lights to be left on in order for the AMOS to work properly.

6.6.3.5. Provide the following to 374 OSS/OSAT and 374 OSS/OSAR:

6.6.3.5.1. Weather indoctrination for the ATC Limited Observation Training as required by CFETP 1C1X1, *Air Traffic Control Operations*.

6.6.3.5.2. Controllers' certification for the limited weather observations on AF Form 3622, *Air Traffic Control/Weather Certification and Rating Record*.

6.6.3.5.3. IWWC notification via JET of all issued, cancelled, or extended weather watches, warnings, and advisories.

6.6.3.5.4. Daily radio checks to ensure proper PMSV operation.

6.6.3.5.5. Monitor frequency 344.6 MHz during normal duty hours, when PMSV is inoperable (until such time 374 OSS/OSAA takes responsibility with the proper equipment).

6.6.3.5.6. Certification of visibility checkpoint charts for main and alternate tower sites.

6.6.3.5.7. Immediate notification when there is a JET outage as well as initiate fix actions through 374 OSS/OSAM.

6.6.3.6. Provide the following to the 36 AS and 459 AS:

6.6.3.6.1. Mission planning and execution weather data according to the daily flying schedule and as required.

6.6.3.6.2. Weather updates for significant weather changes to the AS duty desks for dissemination to off-station aircrews if a POC/MC is not available for direct contact.

6.6.3.6.3. Weather data in person at formal mission briefings as long as the formal briefing is requested in a timely manner and manning/mission requirements allow.

6.6.3.6.4. The Yokota MEF via Mattermost, email, hand-delivery, or fax when the 374 OSS/OSW website is unavailable.

6.6.3.6.5. Provide or arrange for weather briefings and mission watch for all 374 AW missions regardless of departure location and destination (coordination needs to be prearranged by squadrons for flights originating outside of Home Station).

6.6.3.6.6. Quarterly mission forecast accuracy statistics.

6.6.3.7. Provide the following to the 374 OSS/OSAM:

6.6.3.7.1. Notification of meteorological equipment outages.

6.6.3.8. Provide the following to the 374 CES/CEF:

6.6.3.8.1. Contact CE Customer Support 225-5282 or the Snow Control Center (SCC) at 225-5336/9219 or the CE UCC at 225-7310 when snow or ice is forecast for Yokota AB. After duty hours (1615L), contact 225-7290 (Fire Emergency Services Flight who will in turn notify 374 CES Staff Duty Officer), and pass the following information:

6.6.3.8.1.1. Current wind direction and speed.

6.6.3.8.1.2. Forecast wind direction and speed.

6.6.3.8.1.3. High and low temperatures during the period of precipitation.

6.6.3.8.2. Weather information to 374 CES (by request) for their requirement to generate chemical downwind messages (CDM).

6.6.3.8.3. Weather support to any Toxic Corridor forecast and/or fire ground operations planning (by request).

6.6.3.9. Provide the following to the 374 LRS/LGRDX:

6.6.3.9.1. The weather portion of the mobility concept briefing as requested by the Installation Deployment Officer.

6.6.3.10. Provide the following to DTRA:

6.6.3.10.1. Aircrew planning weather the day prior to the mission; weather briefing prior to flight and climatology weather briefings to the inspection team.

6.6.3.10.2. Attend the quarterly New START Treaty (NST) Working Group session when convened.

6.7. 36th and 459th Airlift Squadrons (36 AS and 459 AS) will or should:

6.7.1. Should coordinate with 374 OSS/OSW leadership on mission support feedback, mission verification product accuracy, and support policies annually or on occasions of major publications changes affecting weather minimums required.

6.7.2. Will notify the 374 OSS/OSW of additional support requirements or flying requirements that are not covered in the daily flying schedule.

6.7.3. Will provide contact information for mission clarification and follow-up.

6.7.4. Will provide a completed 374 AW Transient Weather Request form to the 374 OSS/OSW when flying to destinations outside the MEF area.

6.7.5. The 36 AS will serve as the weather flight Alternate Operating Location and will furnish at a minimum: dedicated phone, desk space, and LAN access.

6.7.6. If there are any changes to briefing times/locations, the mission commander will notify the 374 OSS/OSW immediately.

6.7.7. The 459 AS and 36 AS should include 374 OSS/OSW in operational exercises when able.

6.8. 374th Logistics Readiness Squadron (374 LRS) will:

6.8.1. Notify the 374 OSS/OSW of all mobility concept briefings as soon as scheduled.

6.8.1.1. Provide 374 OSS/OSW with all necessary information needed to be presented at the mobility concept briefings.

6.9. 374th Security Forces Squadron (374 SFS) will:

6.9.1. Promptly inform the 374 OSS/OSW of any hazardous weather observed (tornado, hail, etc.).

6.10. 374th Aerospace Medicine Squadron Bioenvironmental Engineering Flight (374 AMDS/SGPB) will:

6.10.1. The SGBP will implement the Heat Stress Advisory and disseminate via phone to 374 AW/CP.

6.11. 374 Civil Engineering Squadron (374 CES) will:

6.11.1. Notify 374 OSS/OSW of any construction that will/may impact power or communication systems in Bldg. 703 and/or to either of the FMQ-19 weather sensors located on the north and south ends of the airfield.

6.11.2. Fix mission essential equipment needed by the 374 OSS/OSW IAW the 374 OSS/RAWS MOA 01 JAN 2019.

6.12. 374 Communications Squadron (374 CS) will:

6.12.1. Fix mission essential equipment needed by the 374 OSS/OSW IAW the 374 OSS/RAWS MOA 01 APR 2024.

6.13. Defense Threat Reduction Agency, Detachment Japan (DTRA/J3OSSJ) will:

6.13.1. Provide mission details necessary for generating weather support.

6.13.2. Provide feedback on actual weather conditions at operational areas.

6.13.3. Quarterly, notify the 374 OSS/OSW when a New START Treaty (NST) Working Group session will convene.

RICHARD F. MCELHANEY, Col, USAF
Commander, 374th Airlift Wing

Attachment 1

GLOSSARY OF REFERENCES AND SUPPORTING INFORMATION

References

AFDD 3-59, *Weather Operations*, 26 September 2025

DAFI 10-401, *Operations Planning and Execution,* 13 January 2021

DAFI 10-2503, *Chemical Biological Radiological, Nuclear (CBRN) Defense Program,* 6 October 2023

AFH 15-101, *Meteorological Techniques*, 5 November 2019

DAFI 15-129, *Air and Space Weather Operations,* 16 September 2025

AFI 17-130, *Cybersecurity Program Management,* 13 February 2020

AFI 33-322*, Records Management and Information Governance Program,* 23 March 2020

DAFI 36-2670, *Total Force Development*, 7 May 2024

AFI 90-802, *Risk Management,* 1 April 2019

AFMAN 10-206*, Operational Reporting,* 1 September 2020

AFMAN 11-210, *Instrument Refresher Program (IRP),* 21 December 2021

AFMAN 11-2C-12, *C-12 Aircrew Training, Operation, and Evaluations*, 12 January 2024

AFMAN 11-2C-130V3, *C-130 Operations Procedures*, 15 December 2023

AFMAN 11-202V3, *Flight Operations,* 10 January 2022

AFMAN 13-204V3, *Air Traffic Control*, 26 April 2024

AFMAN 36-2100, *Military Utilization and Classification*, 7 April 2021

AFMAN 15-111, *Surface Weather Observations,* 12 March 2019

AFMAN 15-124*, Meteorological Codes,* 16 January 2019

DAFMAN 91-203, *Air Force Occupational Safety and Health Standards*, 25 March 2022

AFTTP 3-4, *Airman's Manual,* 26 September 2022

FAA Order 7110.10, *Flight Service*, 5 October 2023

Installation Data Page between 374 OSS and 17 OWS

Joint Publication 3-59, *Meteorology and Oceanographic Operations,* 10 January 2018

PACAFI 15-101, *Weather Support for PACAF,* 17 February 2023

USPACOMINST 0539.1, *PACOM Tropical Cyclone Operations*, 30 March 2020

USFJI 15-4001, *Tropical Cyclone Conditions of Readiness (TCCOR)*, 23 August 2023

Annex H to HQ ACC OPORD 84-12, *Environmental Services (NAOC)*

War Mobilization Plan (Annex CC)

Yokota Air Base Installation Emergency Management Plan 10-2, 5 July 2024

YOKOTA ABI 13-204, *Airfield Operations,* 30 July 2024

YOKOTA ABI 10-203, *Yokota Air Base Command and Control Operations*, 3 August 2023

Adopted Forms

DD Form 175, *Military Flight Plan*

DD Form 175-1, *Flight Weather Briefing*

DD Form 1801, *DoD International Flight Plan*

AF Form 623, *Individual Training Record Folder*

AF Form 797, *Job Qualification Standard Continuation/Command JQS*

AF Form 847, *Recommendation for Change of Publication*

AF Form 1098, *Special Task Certification and Recurring Training*

AF Form 3622, *Air Traffic Control/Weather Certification and Rating Record*

AF Form 3803, *Surface Weather Observation (METAR/SPECI)*

374 OSS/OSW Form 181, *36 AS Mission Execution Forecast*

Abbreviations and Acronyms

AB—Air Base

AEF—Air Expeditionary Force

AF—Air Force

AFB—Air Force Base

AFH—Air Force Handbook

AFI—Air Force Instruction

AFMAN—Air Force Manual

AFWA—Air Force Weather Agency

AFW—Air Force Weather

AFW-WEBS—Air Force Weather Web Services

AGL—Above Ground Level

ALSTG—Altimeter Setting

AMC—Air Mobility Command

AMDS—Aerospace Medicine Squadron

AMOPS—Airfield Management Operations

AMOS—Automated Meteorological Observing System

AOL—Alternate Operating Location

AOR—Area of Responsibility

AS—Airlift Squadron

ATC—Air Traffic Control

AW—Airlift Wing

BEE—Bioenvironmental Engineering

BWW—Basic Weather Watch

CAT—Category

CAT—Crisis Action Team

CBRN—Chemical, Biological, Radiological, Nuclear

CDM—Chemical Downwind Message

CES—Civil Engineering Squadron

COOP—Cooperative Outage Procedures

CP—Command Post

CSAF—Chief of Staff of the Air Force

CS—Communications Squadron

CWW—Cooperative Weather Watch

DLT—Desired Lead Time

DoD—Department of Defense

DTRA—Defense Threat Reduction Agency

EOC—Emergency Operations Center

EU—Exploitation Unit

EWO—Emergency War Orders

FAA—Federal Aviation Administration

FES—Fire Emergency Services

FLIP—Flight Information Publication

FSS—Force Support Squadron

FSSC—Fielded Systems Service Center

GDSS—Global Decision Support System

GMT—Greenwich Mean Time

GPS—Global Positioning System

GR—Hail

GS—Small Hail or Snow Pellets

HF—High Frequency

HQ—Headquarters

IAW—In Accordance With

IDP—Installation Data Page

IFR—Instrument Flight Rules

IRC—Instrument Refresher Course

IWS—Installation Warning System

IWWC—Integrated Weather Warning Capability

JET—Joint Environmental Toolkit

JMO—Joint Meteorological and Oceanographic Officer

JST—Japan Standard Time

JTWC—Joint Typhoon Warning Center

KTS—Knots

LAN—Local Area Network

LOI—Letter of Instruction

MAJCOM—Major Command

MDS—Mission Design Series

MEDEVAC—Medical Evacuation

MEF—Mission Execution Forecast

MEFP—Mission Execution Forecast Processes

METAR—Meteorological Aviation Report

METOC—Meteorological and Oceanographic

METSAT—Meteorological Satellite

METWATCH—Meteorological Watch

MOA—Memorandum of Agreement

MWE—Mission Weather Element

MWP—Mission Weather Product

NAOC—National Airborne Operations Center

NAS—Naval Air Station

NCC—Network Control Center

NCOIC—Non-Commissioned Officer in Charge

NIPRNET—Non-Secure Internet Protocol Router Network

NOTAMS—Notices to Airmen

NST—New START Treaty

NVG—Night Vision Goggles

OG—Operations Group

OIC—Officer in Charge

OPLANS—Operation Plans

OPR—Office of Primary Responsibility

OPREP—Operational Report

ORM—Operational Risk Management

OSAT/OSAR—Operations Support Tower and RAPCON

OSS—Operations Support Squadron

OWA—Observed Weather Advisories

OWS—Operational Weather Squadron

PACAF—Pacific Air Forces

PAOC—Pacific Air and Space Operations Center

PA—Public Affairs, or Pressure Altitude

PIREP—Pilot Report

PMSV—Pilot to Metro Service

POC—Point of Contact

RAPCON—Radar Approach and Control

RCR—Runway Condition Readings

RDS—Air Force Records Disposition Schedule

RSC—Runway Surface Condition

RVR—Runway Visual Change

SATCOM—Satellite Communications

SCC—Snow Control Center

SCN—Secondary Crash Net

SE—Safety Office

SFS—Security Forces Office

SIPRNET—Secure Internet Protocol Router Network

SLP—Sea Level Pressure

SM—Statute Miles

SOP—Standard Operating Procedure

SPECI—Aviation Selected Special Weather Report

SPECI—Special Weather Observation

SPO—System Program Office

SW—Southwest

SWAP—Severe Weather Action Procedures

SWAT—Severe Weather Action Team

TAF—Terminal Aerodrome Forecast

TAWS—Target Acquisition Weather Software

TC—Tropical Cyclone

TCCOR—Tropical Cyclone Condition(s) of Readiness

TDA—Tactical Decision Aid

TMOS—TMQ-53 Tactical Meteorological Observation System

TO—Technical Order

TS—Thunderstorms

TWR—Tower

UCC—Unit Control Center

UFN—Until Further Notice

UHF—Ultra High Frequency

USFJ—United States Forces Japan

USPACOM—United States Pacific Command

VA—Volcanic Ash

VFR—Visual Flight Rules

VHF—Very High Frequency

VIS—Visibility

VMC—VFR Meteorological Condition

VOR—VHF Omni Range

WA—Weather Advisories

WWA—Watches, Warnings, and Advisories

WW—Weather Warning

Attachment 2

TAF AND WEATHER OBSERVATION THRESHOLD CRITERIA

A2.1. TAF Specification Criteria. The elements in the TAF will be specified IAW the guidance in DAFMAN 15-129 Volume 1 and general flight rules stated in AFI 11-202, Volume 3. 17 OWS will issue the TAF using the criteria listed in the following table.

Table A2.1. Yokota AB TAF Specification/Amendment Criteria.

Forecast Element/Occurrence	TAF Specification/Amendment Criteria (AFMAN 15-124)	
Ceiling observed or later expected to decrease to less than, or if below, increase to equal or exceed:	Category E Category D Category C Category B Category A	≥ 2000 feet < 2000 feet but ≥ 1000 feet < 1000 feet but ≥ 800 feet < 800 feet but ≥ 300 feet < 300 feet
Prevailing Visibility observed or later expected to decrease to less than, or if below, increase to equal or exceed:	Category E Category D Category C Category B Category A	≥ 3 SM < 3 SM but > 2 SM < 3 SM but ≥ 2 SM < 2 SM but ≥ 1/2 SM < 1/2 SM
Surface Winds	**Wind Speed:** The difference between the predominant wind speed and the forecast wind speed is ≥ 10 knots **Wind Gusts:** The difference between observed gusts and the forecast is ≥ 10 knots **Wind Direction:** A change > 30 degrees when the predominant wind speed or gusts are expected to be 15 knots or greater	
Icing, not associated with thunderstorms, from the surface to 10,000 feet AGL	The beginning or ending of icing first meets, exceeds, or decreases below moderate or greater thresholds and was not specified in the forecast.	
Turbulence (for CAT II aircraft), not associated with thunderstorms, from the surface to 10,000 feet AGL	The beginning or ending of turbulence first meets, exceeds, or decreases below moderate or greater thresholds (for CAT II aircraft) and was not specified in the forecast.	
Thunderstorms	Incorrect forecast start or end time.	

Weather Warning criteria and/or Weather Advisory criteria	Occur, or are expected to occur during the forecast period, but were not specified in the forecast Specified in the forecast but are no longer expected to occur during the forecast period
Altimeter Setting	Meets or exceeds 31.00 INS and was not specified in the forecast Drops below 31.00 INS and was not specified during the forecast period Drops below 28.00 INS and was not specified in the forecast Increases above 28.00 INS and was not specified in the forecast
Specification of Temporary Conditions	Conditions specified as TEMPO become predominant Conditions specified as TEMPO do not occur during the cardinal hour as forecast Forecast conditions specified as TEMPO are no longer expected to occur
Change to Predominant Conditions	Forecast change conditions occur before the beginning of the specified period of change and are expected to persist Forecast change conditions do not occur within 30 minutes after the specified time Forecast change conditions are no longer expected to occur
Representative Conditions	Forecast conditions are not considered representative of existing or forecast conditions and amending the forecast improves safety, flight planning, operations efficiency, or assistance to in-flight aircraft
Notes: 1. Forecast will specify when conditions decrease to less than or if below, increase to equal or exceed the categories in the table. 2. Forecast category is determined by the lower ceiling or visibility value. 3. Use prevailing surface visibility to determine forecast category 4. 5000 meters may be substituted for 4800 meters at OCONUS locations based on the host-nation national practice.	

A2.2. Weather Observation SPECI Criteria. SPECI observations are taken when certain weather criteria occur as defined in AFMAN 15-124, AFI 11-202V3, AFI 13-204V3, DOD FLIP, and local requirements. Criteria for Yokota AB are in the tables listed below.

Table A2.2. Observation SPECI Criteria Ceiling and Prevailing Visibility for Yokota AB.

Criteria Type	Pertinent Data	Guidance

Ceiling observed to: from below OR decrease to less than OR if below, increase to equal or exceed	3,000 feet	(AFMAN 15-111)
	2,000 feet	(AFMAN 15-111, AFI 11-202V3)
	1,500 feet	(AFMAN 15-111, AFI 11-202V3)
	1,200 feet	(FLIP)
	1,000 feet	(AFMAN 15-111, AFI 11-202V3, AFI 13-204V3)
	900 feet	(FLIP)
	800 feet	(AFMAN 15-111, AFI 13-204V3, FLIP)
	700 feet	(AFMAN 15-111, FLIP)
	600 feet	(DOD FLIP)
	500 feet	(AFMAN 15-111, FLIP)
	400 feet	(FLIP)
	300 feet	(FLIP)
	200 feet	(AFI 13-204V3, FLIP)
Visibility observed to: decrease to less than OR if below, increase to equal or exceed	3 sm (4800 meters)	(AFMAN 15-111, AFI 11-202V3,13-204V3, FLIP)
	2 1/2 sm (4000 meters)	(FLIP)
	2 sm (3200 meters)	(AFMAN 15-111, AFI 13-204V3, FLIP)
	1 7/8 sm (3000 meters)	(FLIP)
	1 3/4 sm (2800 meters)	(FLIP)
	1 5/8 sm (2500 meters)	(FLIP Radar Aprch Mins)
	1 ½ sm (2400 meters)	(AFMAN 15-111)
	1 3/8 sm (2200 meters)	(FLIP)
	1 1/4 sm (2000 meters)	(FLIP)
	1 sm (1600 meters)	(AFMAN 15-111, AFI 11-202V3, 13-204V3, FLIP)
	3/4 sm (1200 meters)	(FLIP)

	1/2 sm (800 meters)	(AFI 13-204V3, FLIP)
	1/4 sm (400 meters)	(AFMAN 15-111)

Table A2.3. Observation SPECI Local Criteria.

Criteria Type	Pertinent Data	Guidance
Runway Visual Range (RVR) is observed to:	≤ 1 sm (1600 meters)	(AFMAN 15-111)
	> 1 sm (1600 meters)	(AFMAN 15-111)
Runway Visual Range (RVR) observed to: decrease to less than OR if below, increase to equal or exceed	6000 feet (>1500 meters)	(AFMAN 15-111)
	5500 feet (>1500 meters)	(AFMAN 15-111, FLIP)
	5000 feet (1500 meters)	(AFMAN 15-111)
	4500 feet (1370 meters)	(AFMAN 15-111, AFI 13-204V3, FLIP)
	4000 feet (1200 meters)	(AFMAN 15-111, AFI 13-204V3, FLIP)
	2400 feet (750 meters)	(FLIP)
	2000 feet (600 meters)	(AFMAN 15-111)
Precipitation that begins, ends, or changes intensity, or changes to or from one of these types:	Freezing Rain	(AFMAN 15-111)
	Freezing Drizzle	(AFMAN 15-111)
	Ice Pellets	(AFMAN 15-111)
Precipitation, any type (i.e., rain, snow, hail)	Begins or ends	(AFMAN 15-111)
Sky Condition	Clouds observed below 1200 feet (when not in previous observation)	(AFMAN 15-111)
Thunderstorms	Begins (not required if another storm is on station) OR Ends (15 minutes after last occurrence on station)	(AFMAN 15-111)
Tornado	Beginning (observed) and ending time (disappears from sight)	(AFMAN 15-111)
Volcanic Eruptions	When observed or disappears from sight.	(AFMAN 15-111)
Wind Shift	If the wind direction changes by 45 degrees or more in less than 15 minutes when	(AFMAN 15-111)

	sustained winds are at least 10 knots	
Squall (SQ)	Sudden onset of wind speed increase of at least 16 knots sustained at 22 knots or more for at least 1 minute.	(AFMAN 15-111)
Upon resumption of observing	Issue a SPECI within 15 minutes after returning to duty following a break in hourly coverage, but not if METAR is issued during those 15 minutes	
Miscellaneous	Any other meteorological situation that in forecaster's opinion is critical	
Observation Local Criteria: Altimeter setting for Yokota AB.		
Criteria Type	**Pertinent Data**	
Pressure: During back-up of AMOS pressure sensor	LOCAL altimeter setting observations are taken at an interval not to exceed 35 minutes when there has been a change of 0.01 inch Hg (0.3 hPa) or more since the last ALSTG value.	

Attachment 3

AIRCRAFT WEATHER LIMITATIONS AND SENSITIVITIES

Table A3.1. USAF General Weather Limitations Ref: AFI 11-202V3 Paragraph 8.7.1.1.

Weather Condition	Impact	Customer Action
Ceiling < 2,000 ft Visibility < 3 mi	Alternate required	Add fuel to allow divert
Ceiling < 800 ft Visibility < 2 mi	Terminal may not be favorable for alternate	Review Alternate Requirements

Figure A3.1. 374 OSS/OSW Mission Tailored Weapon Systems (Airframes) Weather NO-GO Thresholds. Note: All information comes from the following regulations: (a) C-130: AFI 11-2C-130V3 (b) C-12: AFI 11-2C-12V3 (c) UH-1: AFI 11-2UH-1NV3 (d) local 36/459 AS regulations.

***Note: Mission Commanders will highlight any changes to mission weather thresholds and air drop sensitivities that are not listed in this table via the weather briefing request form.**

Table A3.2. Operating Frequencies for Solar Activity.

	C-130	C-12	UH-1
UHF Radio	225.0 - 399.9	225.0 - 399.975	225.0 – 399.975
VHF Radio	116.0 - 151.92	108.0 - 173.975 (**see Note**)	116.0 - 151.975
HF Radio	2.0000 - 29.9999	2.0000 - 29.9999	N/A
VOR Receiver	108.00 - 115.97	108.00 - 117.95	108.00 - 118.00
Note: 8.33 spacing available 118.0 - 136.975			

Attachment 4

CUSTOMER WEATHER LIMITATIONS AND SENSITIVITIES

A4.1. General: The following tables identify impacts to 374 AW and Yokota AB associated agencies when weather watches, warnings, and advisories are issued, and the customers' action. Associated agencies include the Tama Hills Annex of Yokota AB.

Table A4.1. Customer Weather Limitations and Sensitivities.

YOKOTA AB WEATHER WATCHES	DLT (in mins)	ISSUED BY	IMPACTS TO OPERATIONS	CUSTOMER ACTIONS
Lightning within 5 nm	30 min	374 OSS/OSW	**CES** - No outside operations for all shops **Flyers** - Flight line personnel sent inside-no support available for take- off and landing. **All:** May delay operations.	**CES** - Notify civilian and military personnel via radio, or telephone of weather warning. Instruct all personnel to cease outdoor work **Flyers** - May restrict take- offs and recoveries **FSS** - Clear pool, golf course, outdoor sports activities
Tornado	As Potential Warrants	374 OSS/OSW	**CES** - IAW YAB OPLAN 10-2, *Disaster Operations Plan*- set up for recovery as needed **Flyers** - Flight line personnel sent inside-no support available for take- off and landing	**Flyers** - May restrict take- offs and recoveries. **All -** Seek shelter, hangar or divert aircraft.

Moderate Thunderstorm	As Potential Warrants	374 OSS/OSW	**CES** - No outside operations for all shops **Flyers** - Flight line personnel sent inside-no support available for take- off and landing. **All:** May delay operations. **All:** Personal injury, equipment damage	**CES** - Instruct all personnel to cease outdoor work. **Flyers** - May restrict take- offs and recoveries **All** - Seek shelter, hangar or divert aircraft.
Severe Thunderstorm	As Potential Warrants	374 OSS/OSW	**CES** - No outside operations for all shops **Flyers** - Flight line personnel sent inside-no support available for take- off and landing. **All:** May delay operations. **All:** Personal injury, equipment damage	**CES** - Instruct all personnel to cease outdoor work. **Flyers** - May restrict take- offs and recoveries **All** - Seek shelter, hangar or divert aircraft.

Freezing Precipitation	As Potential Warrants	374 OSS/OSW	**CES** - Increase barrier arresting kit checks **Flyers** - All ice, snow and frost must be removed from the entire aircraft before take-off **All:** Delay or cease operations.	**CES** - Recall Power Pro technicians **AMXS –** Deice aircraft. Hangar or protect aircraft. **Flyers** – Evaluate weather ORM factors for mission execution
Surface Winds ≥ 50 knots	As Potential Warrants	374 OSS/OSW	**CES** - Limited outdoor work for all personnel **CES** - Horizontal Section--no crane operations **CES** - Electrical Section--no bucket truck operation **Flyers** - A large crosswind component and slick surface conditions may prevent a safe take- off. **All:** Equipment damage.	**CES** - Notify technicians of weather conditions and cautionary measures **CES** - Recall all personnel and initiate telephone standby **CES** - Housing inspectors or designees would need to drive through the housing area and notify residents to tie down outside furniture, trampolines, etc., and secure anything else that could be picked up by the wind and cause damage to it or our housing units. **AMXS –** Add Fuel/Chains or Hangar aircraft. **Flyers -** Evaluate weather ORM factors for mission execution **All** - Secure light objects outside.

Heavy Rain ≥ 2 inches in 6 hours	As Potential Warrants	374 OSS/OSW	**CES** - Horizontal Section switch work priority from DSW to drain maintenance **CES** - HVAC and Electrical Sections -- limited outdoor work	**CES** - Recall and initiate telephone standby for Horizontal Section personnel
Heavy Snow Accumulation ≥ 2 inches in 12 hours	As Potential Warrants	374 OSS/OSW	**CES** - Shift to snow removal **CES** - Increase barrier arresting kit checks **CES** - Limited service contracts **Flyers -** All ice, snow and frost must be removed from the entire aircraft before take-off.	**CES** - Recall snow removal team and initiate telephone standby. **CES** - Recall Power Pro technicians **AMXS** - Deice aircraft prior to take-off **Flyers** - Evaluate weather ORM factors for mission execution
Blizzard	As Potential Warrants	374 OSS/OSW	**CES** - Shift to snow removal **CES** - Increase barrier arresting kit checks **CES** - Limited service contracts **Flyers -** All ice, snow and frost must be removed from the entire aircraft before take-off. **All:** May delay operations.	**CES** - Recall snow removal team and initiate telephone standby. **CES** - Recall Power Pro technicians **AMXS** - Deice aircraft prior to take-off (airfield operations limited) **Flyers** - Evaluate weather ORM factors for mission execution

Excessive Rainfall ≥ 4 1/2 inches in 24 hours	48 Hours	374 OSS/OSW	**CES –** Shift to prepare flood - high risk areas	**CES –** Start barriers for high-risk areas **CES** – Prepare for sandbag distribution **CES –** Inform residents to prepare.
TAMA SERVICE ANNEX (of Yokota AB) WEATHER WATCH	**DLT (in mins)**	**ISSUED BY**	**IMPACTS TO OPERATIONS**	**CUSTOMER ACTIONS**
Lightning within 5 nm	30	374 OSS/OSW	**FSS** - No outside operations.	**FSS** - Suspend recreation activities. Instruct all personnel to cease outdoor work
YOKOTA AB WEATHER WARNINGS	**DLT (in mins)**	**ISSUED BY**	**IMPACTS TO OPERATIONS**	**CUSTOMER ACTIONS**
Lightning within 5 nm	Observed	374 OSS/OSW	**CES** - No outside operations for all shops **Flyers** - Flight line personnel sent inside-no support available for take- off and landing. **All:** May delay operations.	**CES** - Notify civilian and military personnel via radio, telephone of weather warning. Instruct all personnel to cease outdoor work. **Flyers** - May restrict take offs and recoveries **OSAA** - Cease airfield work. **FSS** - Clear pool, golf course, outdoor sports activities

Tornado	30	374 OSS/OSW	**CES** - IAW 10-2-- No plan required for Yokota (set up for recovery as needed) **Flyers** - Flight line personnel sent inside-no support available for take- off and landing	**Flyers** - May restrict take- offs and recoveries. **All -** Seek shelter, hangar or divert aircraft**.**
Moderate Thunderstorm	90	374 OSS/OSW	**CES** - No outside operations for all shops **Flyers** - Flight line personnel sent inside-no support available for take- off and landing. **All** - Personal injury, equipment damage, may delay operations.	**CES** - Instruct all personnel to cease outdoor work. **Flyers** - May restrict take- offs and recoveries **OSAA**- Cease airfield work. **FSS** - Clear pool, golf course, outdoor sports activities **All** - Seek shelter, hangar or divert aircraft.
Severe Thunderstorm	120	374 OSS/OSW	**CES** - No outside operations for all shops **Flyers** - Flight line personnel sent inside-no support available for take- off and landing. **All:** Personal injury, equipment damage, may delay operations**.**	**CES** - Instruct all personnel to cease outdoor work. **Flyers** - May restrict take- offs and recoveries **OSAA** - Cease airfield work. **FSS** - Clear pool, golf course, outdoor sports activities **All** - Seek shelter, hangar or divert aircraft.

Freezing Precipitation	90	374 OSS/OSW	**CES** - Increase barrier arresting kit checks **Flyers** - All ice, snow and frost must be removed from the entire aircraft before take-off. **All:** Delay or cease operations.	**CES** - Recall Power Pro technicians **Flyers** – May restrict take-offs and recoveries **AMXS** - Deice aircraft prior to take-off
Surface Winds ≥ 35 knots but < 50 knots	90	374 OSS/OSW	**CES** - Limited outdoor work for all personnel **CES** - Horizontal Section--no crane operations **CES** - Electrical Section--no bucket truck operation **Flyers** - A large crosswind component and slick surface conditions may prevent a safe take-off	**CES** - Notify technicians of weather conditions and cautionary measures **AMXS** - Add Fuel/Chains or Hangar aircraft
Surface Winds ≥ 50 knots	120	374 OSS/OSW	**CES** - Limited outdoor work for all personnel--mission essential only **CES** - Horizontal Section--no	**CES** - Notify technicians of weather conditions and cautionary measures **CES** - Recall all personnel and initiate telephone standby

			crane operations **CES** - Electrical Section--no bucket truck operation **Flyers** - A large crosswind component and slick surface conditions may prevent a safe take- off **All:** Equipment damage.	**CES** - Housing inspectors or designees would need to drive through the housing area and notify residents to tie down outside furniture, trampolines, etc., and secure anything else that could be picked up by the wind and cause damage to it or our housing units. **AMXS** – Add Fuel/Chains or Hangar aircraft **Flyers** – May restrict take-offs and recoveries **All** - Secure light objects outside.
Heavy Rain ≥ 2 inches in 6 hours	90	374 OSS/OSW	**CES** - Horizontal Section switch work priority from DSW to drain maintenance **CES -** HVAC and Electrical Sections -- limited outdoor work	**CES** - Recall and initiate telephone standby for Horizontal Section personnel

Snow accumulation ≥ 2 inches in 12 hours	90	374 OSS/OSW	**CES** - Shift to snow removal **CES** - Increase barrier arresting kit checks **CES –** Limited-service contracts **Flyers** - All ice, snow and frost must be removed from the entire aircraft before take-off	**CES** - Recall snow removal team and initiate telephone standby **CES** - Recall Power Pro technicians **AMXS** - Deice aircraft prior to take-off
Blizzard	90	374 OSS/OSW	**CES** - Shift to snow removal **CES** - Increase barrier arresting kit checks **CES** - Limited service contracts **Flyers -** All ice, snow and frost must be removed from the entire aircraft before take-off. **All:** May delay operations.	**CES** - Recall snow removal team and initiate telephone standby. **CES** - Recall Power Pro technicians **AMXS** - Deice aircraft prior to take-off (airfield operations limited)
Excessive Rainfall ≥ 4 1/2 inches in 24 hours	18 hrs	374 OSS/OSW	**CES** – Preventative measures for flood prone areas	**CES –**Distribute sandbags for facilities
TAMA SERVICE ANNEX (of Yokota AB) WEATHER WARNING	**DLT (in mins)**	**ISSUED BY**	**IMPACTS TO OPERATIONS**	**CUSTOMER ACTIONS**

Lightning within 5 nm	Observed	374 OSS/OSW	**FSS -** No outside operations	**FSS** - Suspend recreation activities
YOKOTA AB WEATHER ADVISORIES	**DLT (in mins)**	**ISSUED BY**	**IMPACTS TO OPERATIONS**	**CUSTOMER ACTIONS**
Surface Winds ≥ 25 knots but < 35 knots	Observed	374 OSS/OSW	**CES -** Danger to communication antennas, roofing, scaffolding, and similar construction.	**CES** - CE and CS personnel secure loose equipment. **OSAA** - Cease wing walking on large aircraft.
Snow Accumulation ≥ 1/2 inch	120	374 OSS/OSW	**Flyers** - All ice, snow and frost must be removed from the aircraft before take-off	**AMXS -** Deice aircraft prior to take-off
Freezing Temperature	Observed	374 OSS/OSW	**MXG -** Potential equipment failure	**MXG –** Increased maintenance timing
Crosswinds ≥ 25 knots	Observed	374 OSS/OSW	**Flyers -** Advisory in nature. Flight hazard	**Flyers** - AMC aircraft, tankers advisory thresholds. C-12 will not take-off or land
Low-Level Wind Shear below 2,000 feet	Observed	374 OSS/OSW	**Flyers** - Reported wind shear will prevent take-off/landings	**Flyers -** Delay operations until safe conditions are present
Moderate or Greater Turbulence below 10,000 feet AGL	Observed	374 OSS/OSW	**Flyers -** Advisory in nature	**Flyers** - Advisory in nature to aircrews; does not restrict operations

Moderate or Greater Icing below 10,000 feet AGL	Observed	374 OSS/OSW	**Flyers -** Advisory in nature	**Flyers** - Advisory in nature to aircrews; does not restrict operations
Heat Stress Advisory	Observed	374 AMDS/SGPB	**MXG/CES -** ORM- designed local requirement. Personnel hazard	**MXG/CES** - safety advisory for outdoor crews. Work/rest cycle for outdoor crews.